RANDOL (HONGYU) YAO

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | PhD 2023 - present
Technology Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Strategic Management (TIES)

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | MS 2025
Management Research

University of California, Berkeley | BA (Highest Distinction) 2022
Economics and Data Science (Highest Honors, *Departmental Citation*)

WORKING PAPERS

Patent Exposure and the Diffusion of "Trapped Knowledge" (Under Review)

The Geography of Science (with Abhishek Nagaraj) (NBER W34694) (Under Review)
Media Coverage: The Economist, NBER Digest, CEPR VoxEU

AI evaluation may bias perceptions: The importance of context in interpreting academic writing (with Shang Wu)

ONGOING PROJECTS

Diffusion of Knowledge in Traditional Medicine (with Joey Ryu)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Namrata Kala, MIT 2026
Research Assistant to Professor Jacob Moscona, MIT 2024
Predoctoral Research Assistant to Professor Abhishek Nagaraj, UC Berkeley 2022-2023

HONORS & GRANTS

NBER Economics of Science Initiative Travel Grant 2026
NBER Innovation Information Initiative (I3) Fellow 2025
Clausen Center for International Business and Policy Grant 2023
MIT Presidential Graduate Fellowship 2023
Steve Goldman Memorial Prize and Departmental Citation 2022
Berkeley Experimental Social Science Laboratory (Xlab) Grant 2021
Michael and Chris Boskin Scholarship 2021

REFEREEING SERVICE

Nature Methods
Organization Science
Academy of Management

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND BOOK CHAPTERS

From 'May' to 'Is': Certainty Distortion in Language Model Rewriting (2026) *The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)* (with Belém, C., Wu, S., Steyvers, M., Singh, S., Smyth, P.)

The Impact of AI Usage and Informativeness on Skill Development in Logical Reasoning (2026) *The 5th International Conference on Hybrid Human-Artificial Intelligence* (with Wu, S., Belém, C., Fu, S., Steyvers, M., Smyth, P.)

Geographic Inequality in Management Scholarship: Data-Driven Estimates and Trends (2025) (invited to be published in *Research in the Sociology of Organizations*) (with Abhishek Nagaraj)

TEACHING

MIT Sloan School of Management:

TA for Professor Danielle Li – Competitive Strategy Boot Camp	2026
TA for Professor Erin Scott – Entrepreneurial Funding & Teams	2026
TA for Professor Erin Scott & Scott Stern – Entrepreneurial Strategy	2026
TA for Professor Pierre Azoulay & Scott Stern – Economics of Ideas and Innovation	2025
TA for Professor Sean Willems – Introduction to Operations Management	2024-2027

UC Berkeley Department of Economics:

TA for Professor James Campbell – Intermediate Microeconomic	2021-2022

PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCES

2027: American Economics Association*
2026: Academy of Management, NBER Innovation Research Boot Camp, Science for Development Conference, Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium
2025: Harvard Economics of Science & Engineering Seminar, Academy of Management
(* scheduled)

SKILLS

Programming	Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS
Languages	Mandarin, Wu Languages, English, Japanese (Preliminary)